First- and second-line infrastructure support

- Day to day: log and resolve tickets within service levels, set up laptops and accounts, diagnose network and hardware faults, escalate what I cannot fix (adverts 1, 4, 5, 8)
- Target advert: Warehouse Systems Support, GXO (Inteq), Milton Keynes, £26–32k, hybrid, 24/7 rotating shifts
- Why it fits: IBM 24/7 support and my own ISP (2000–07), seven years in UK logistics, used to night shifts and driving
- Why it matters to me: a realistic first step back into IT from my current employer, with a route to infrastructure and cloud

Sources: GXO Logistics (2026); advert log, portfolio Appendix A.

Microsoft skills lead; AWS barely appears at entry level

£28,250

UK median salary, 1st Line Support (6 months to 20 Oct 2026)

355

permanent 1st Line Support adverts in the same period

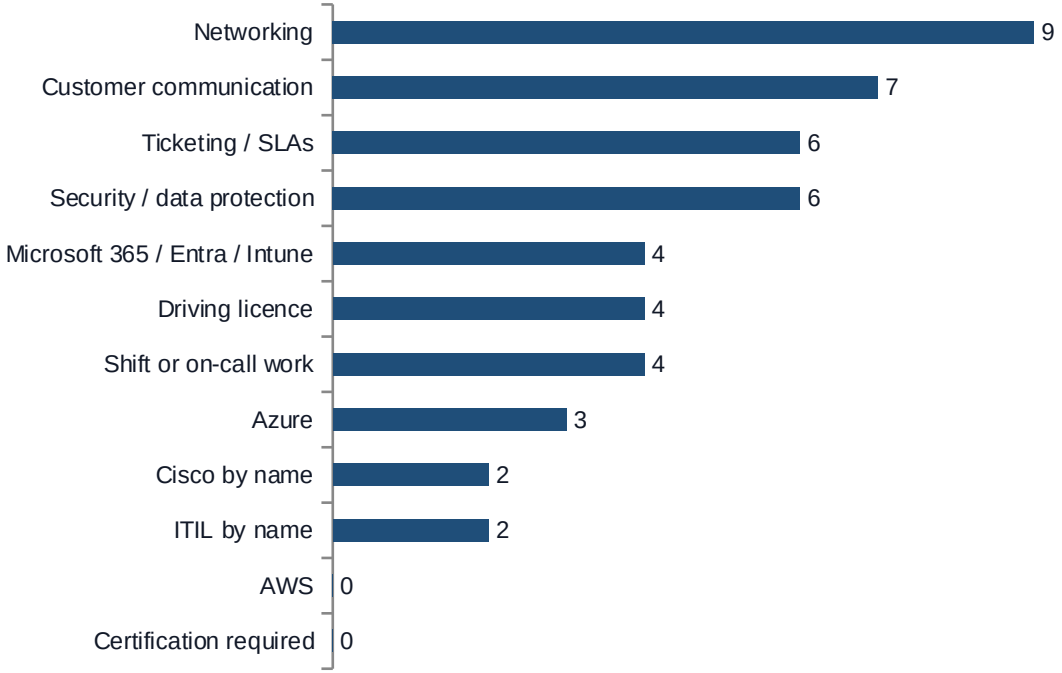
52.7%

of those adverts ask for Microsoft 365; Azure 12.1%; AWS not in the top 30

- My sample: salaries from £24,000 to £50,000; three of ten adverts gave no salary
- Infrastructure roles a step up (data centre, systems administration) pay £35–50k in the sample

Sources: ITJobsWatch (2026); advert log (Reed.co.uk, seen 21 Oct 2026).

Skill tally across ten adverts



What the tally says

Networking is near universal, and my strongest area, but my evidence is old.

No advert required a certificate: employers filter on recent practice.

Essential and desirable kept apart: Azure, SQL and MSP experience appear mostly as desirable.

Sources: Advert log, portfolio Appendix A (10 adverts, Reed.co.uk, 21 Oct 2026).

One local, one national and one international employer

Local: Rugby Borough Council

Application and Infrastructure Support Analyst

£33,673–37,563; hybrid up to 60%

Asks for current infrastructure experience, GDPR and cyber awareness

Offers: pension, flexi time, learning and development

National: Exponential-e

Data Centre Technician 24/7, Corsham

Some hands-on experience; DC experience not required

Copper and fibre cabling, ticketing, ITIL; security clearance; own car

Offers: in-house training and a route into wider roles

International: GXO (Inteq)

Warehouse Systems Support, Milton Keynes

£26–32k; hybrid; 24/7 rotating shifts

Logistics knowledge, troubleshooting, communication; SQL and Azure desirable

Offers: internal route for me; 33 days leave; private medical

Sources: Rugby Borough Council (2026); Exponential-e (2026); GXO Logistics (2026).

Tally against my Task 1.1 self-assessment

Gap	Evidence	Table 7 goal
Microsoft 365 and Entra ID	4/10 adverts; 52.7% nationally	MS-900 by 31 Mar 2027
Azure (not AWS)	3/10 adverts; AWS 0/10	AZ-900 by 31 Jan 2027
Recent networking evidence	9/10 adverts; my practice ended 2007	Three Packet Tracer labs on GitHub by 28 Feb 2027
Live ticket and SLA practice	6/10 adverts; Jira tracked late	Ticket-style log for all work; apply to GXO by 27 Nov 2026

Sources: Portfolio sections 1.1 and Task 2, Table 7; ITJobsWatch (2026).

From night driver to infrastructure engineer

Now (2026)

Night HGV driver at GXO; FdSc Computing completed Nov 2026; public portfolio on GitHub

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Next (2027)

Warehouse Systems Support or 1st/2nd line role; AZ-900 and MS-900; network labs

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Then (2028–29)

Infrastructure or systems administrator; Azure Administrator (AZ-104) or CCNA; Level 6 top-up

→

Longer term

Cloud or network engineer, building on networking and support experience

Sources: Portfolio Task 2, Table 7.